



The Lean Bylaws, TL;DR

The proposed lean bylaws keep every right and protection the Chapter has won and move operating detail into the Codes, Rules, and Policies below, which the membership still controls. The membership votes August 24 and September 28, 2026; where this overview and the bylaws differ, the bylaws govern.

- **Membership and rights.** National DSA members who live or work in the sixteen-county territory are members; dues are voluntary, never a condition of any right; members attend, speak, vote, run, and inspect records; caucuses and open critique are protected; home addresses and sign-in lists stay private.
- **Officers.** Two Co-Chairs, a Secretary, a Treasurer, and a Steward for internal organizing form the Steering Committee, the Chapter's board of directors, with open meetings. Officers serve one-year terms without pay and can be removed for cause; an interim appointment needs membership confirmation within forty-five days.
- **Meetings and votes.** General Meetings at least monthly plus an Annual Convention each July, all hybrid by right: remote members count and vote equally, no proxies. Ordinary actions pass by majority at a five percent quorum, minimum six; nine heightened actions, from amending the bylaws to expelling a member or endorsing a candidate, need two thirds at a ten percent quorum, minimum twelve. Any five members can force an item onto the agenda.
- **Elections.** Nominations run from thirty to five days before an election, with self-nomination allowed; contested elections use secret ballots; National delegates are elected by Scottish Single Transferable Vote; voting in an election takes thirty days of standing (motions take none).
- **Discipline and grievance.** Only the membership can suspend or expel, on twenty-one days notice with the evidence, a hearing, and appeal to the National Political Committee; a political expulsion is decided by the membership; elected Harassment Grievance Officers handle complaints under the national policy, with no waiting period to file.
- **The four tiers.** The bylaws are Tier 1, hardest to change; Codes take two meetings and a two-thirds vote; Rules one meeting and a majority on seven days notice; Policies are Steering Committee administration the membership can override; nothing below may reduce what the bylaws fix.
- **Motions and Resolutions.** Alongside the tiers the Chapter acts by motion, and a motion written out may be styled a Resolution. A motion decides one question once and never becomes standing law. Acting against an adopted motion that directs someone after the meeting ends is null and void, whether or not it was styled a Resolution, on the same footing as acting against a Policy and only so far as the adopting body could bind that officer, body, or member, though the bare decision to endorse, take a position, or recess is outside that.

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The Secretary records nullity, within fourteen days of a member's written request, subject to appeal to the membership.

- **Changes to weigh.** Any five members can put a bylaws amendment directly to the membership, unscreened and unblockable; adoption takes two thirds at the higher quorum at two meetings, up from the 2016 bylaws' simple majorities. Inactive bodies can lapse or be dissolved with notice and a cure window (Youth Section excepted); motions and Resolutions are named and bounded for the first time, and acting against an adopted motion is void the same as acting against a Policy; Rule notice drops to seven days; the maximum suspension is one year, double the earlier draft's cap.